

STUDY GUIDE

Gospel Foundations

A four-session guide for understanding grace, new life and faithful response.

Editorial preview edition - prepared for ministry review

How to use this guide

Use this guide personally, with a friend or in a small group. Each session is designed for 45-60 minutes and moves from observation to reflection and practice.

A simple rhythm

Read the listed passages in your preferred Bible translation. Notice what the text reveals about God, people and faithful response. Discuss without rushing. Choose one practice for the week. Return to the next session ready to share what changed.

Important note

This is an original editorial formation guide, not a substitute for pastoral care or a final doctrinal statement. Scripture references are provided without reproduced translation text so readers can use an approved translation.

Session 1 - The good news begins with God

Scripture pathway: Genesis 1:26-31; Psalm 8; John 1:1-5

Core idea

The Christian story begins with the goodness, wisdom and initiative of God. Identity is received before it is performed, and creation is a gift before it becomes a task.

Reflect together

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| 1. What do these passages reveal about God as Creator? |
| 2. Where are you tempted to build identity only from achievement? |
| 3. What would it mean to receive life as gift this week? |

Practise this

Begin each morning by naming three gifts you have received before naming three tasks you must complete.

Prayer direction

*God of life, teach us to receive before we strive, to worship before we work
and to carry your goodness into what we build.*

Session 2 - Grace meets us truthfully

Scripture pathway: Romans 3:21-26; Luke 15:11-24; Ephesians 2:1-10

Core idea

Grace does not deny what is broken. It tells the truth about sin, restores relationship and creates a new way of living that cannot be purchased by performance.

Reflect together

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| 1. How is grace different from avoidance or indulgence? |
| 2. Which part of the returning son's story is hardest for you to receive? |
| 3. How can gratitude reshape your response to God? |

Practise this

Write a short account of where grace has met you truthfully. End with one concrete expression of gratitude.

Prayer direction

Merciful God, free us from hiding and self-salvation. Help us receive grace with humility and live from gratitude.

Session 3 - New life has a new centre

Scripture pathway: John 15:1-11; Galatians 2:19-20; Colossians 3:1-17

Core idea

Christian formation is not cosmetic improvement. Life is re-centred in Christ so that attention, desire, relationships and action can be reordered over time.

Reflect together

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| 1. What does abiding suggest about the pace of growth? |
| 2. Which old pattern most competes for the centre of your life? |
| 3. What practice helps you remain attentive to Christ? |

Practise this

Choose one daily cue - waking, commuting or eating - and attach a two-minute prayer of attention to it.

Prayer direction

*Christ our life, become the centre of our attention, choices and relationships.
Form in us what effort alone cannot produce.*

Session 4 - Formed people become sent people

Scripture pathway: Matthew 5:13-16; 2 Corinthians 5:14-20; 1 Peter 4:8-11

Core idea

The Gospel gathers and restores people so their lives can become signs of God's reconciling love. Gifts mature through service, and influence becomes stewardship.

Reflect together

1. Where has God already placed you to carry life?
2. Which gift can you offer without needing visibility?
3. What would faithful influence look like in one relationship?

Practise this

Perform one quiet act of service this week. Do not post about it. Pay attention to what the act reveals about your motives.

Prayer direction

God of mission, make our growth useful to others. Give us courage to serve, wisdom to speak and humility to remain faithful.

Continue the journey

Growth becomes durable when reflection turns into repeated practice. Revisit the session that most challenged you, share one insight with a trusted person and choose one faithful action to continue for the next thirty days.

Know. Become. Belong. Serve. Influence.

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